VOL. I · NO. 5
DIWALI EDITION

MUMBAI
EDITED FOR SHARVIN SHAH

The Jarvis Gazette

All the world, before your coffee.

SUNDAY - NOVEMBER 08, 2026 | MUMBAI, INDIA | EDITION NO. 5

₹ Indian Money

STOCK MARKET · DIWALI TRADING · YOUR WALLET

SENSEX · WEEK	NIFTY 50 · WEEK	VALUE ADDED · BSE FIRMS	FOREIGN FUNDS BOUGHT	RUPEE · PER US DOLLAR
81,028	25,030	₹28.7 lakh cr	₹35,781 cr	₹93.91
▲ 8.82%	▲ 8.58%	in 5 days	last 5 sessions	Friday

THE BIG STORY · HAPPY DIWALI

Best week since 2021, and today the market opens on a Sunday, just for an hour

After a week that added ₹28.7 lakh crore to the value of BSE-listed companies, the exchanges open this afternoon for Muhurat trading, Diwali's lucky first trade of the new year.

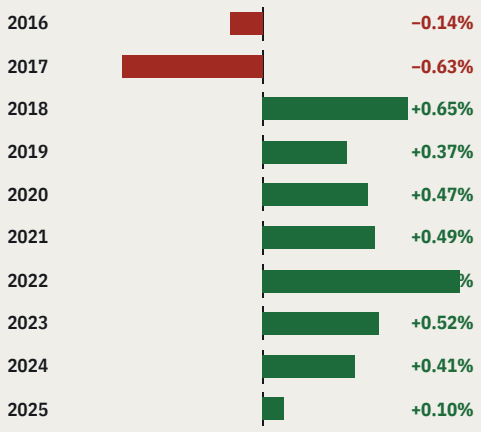
What a week it was. The **Sensex** began on Monday at 74,459.53 and ended Friday at 81,028.02, a gain of **6,568.49 points, or 8.82%**. The **Nifty 50** rose 1,977.25 points, or 8.58%, to 25,030.35. HDFC Sky calls it the best week since 2021, with seven winning days in a row.

The fuel was foreign money. Overseas funds bought shares worth **₹35,781 crore** in five sessions, nearly ₹15,000 crore on Thursday alone. Interestingly, Indian funds (called DIIs) sold ₹18,228 crore so far this month, cashing in some gains. Cheaper oil (Brent fell about 16% from its highs to near $99) also helped.

Today, 2:20 to 3:30 PM: NSE and BSE hold their special **Muhurat trading** session for Lakshmi Puja. A short pre-open runs from 2:05 PM. Every trade is real and settles like any normal trade. Then the market rests again: **Tuesday 10 November is a holiday** for Diwali Balipratipada, though Monday is a normal trading day.

A note of caution: the rally was led by giant companies. On Friday more shares fell than rose (1,037 up against 1,769 down), and the "fear gauge" India VIX jumped 13% to 17.66. Big weeks often bring bumpy days after.

NIFTY IN THE LAST 10 MUHURAT SESSIONS



Up in 8 of 10 years, but never by more than 1%. A tradition, not a money machine.

TODAY'S TIMETABLE (IST)

- 1:50 PM · Block deals for big investors
- 2:05 PM · Pre-open: orders placed
- 2:20 PM · Normal trading begins
- 3:30 PM · Closing bell

NEW TO THIS? WORDS FROM TODAY'S STORY

Muhurat
An auspicious moment. Muhurat trading is a short session that opens the new Hindu accounting year, Samvat 2083.

FII / DII
Foreign and Domestic Institutional Investors: big funds from abroad and from India (mutual funds, insurers).

Market cap
A company's share price times its number of shares: what the whole company is worth on the market.

Pre-open
A few minutes before trading when orders are collected to find a fair opening price.

WHAT THIS MEANS FOR YOU

Many families buy one share or start a monthly investment plan (a SIP) on Diwali as a good-luck gesture. That's a lovely habit if you keep it small and keep going. Don't chase a share just because it rose 8% last week: the next week can easily give some of it back.

VARSITY-STYLE EXPLAINER: WHY FOREIGN MONEY MOVES THE MARKET SO MUCH

Think of the market as an auction. When a buyer with a very deep wallet walks in, prices rise to meet them. Foreign funds manage huge sums, so when they decide India looks cheap compared with the US (where shares fell this week, page 2), even a small shift of their money lifts Indian prices sharply.

BUSINESS BRIEFS

DATA CENTRES
Adani's Vizag deal
AdaniConneX's purchase of the Vizag Data Centre Park is expected to be completed by 10 November, HDFC Sky reports.

IPO WATCH
Mahanadi Coalfields
The Coal India unit's share sale is expected in the second half of November or early December, opening a busy listing season.

HOLIDAY
Closed on Tuesday
Shares won't trade on 10 November. On MCX, the commodity exchange, the morning session is shut but the evening session runs.

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Shape tomorrow's paper

Scan with your phone camera to rate today's edition and tell the editor what you want more or less of. Tomorrow's paper reads your answers before it is written.

Or tap here to open the feedback desk

Sources: HDFC Sky weekly wrap, 7 Nov (week, FII/DII, VIX, rupee, briefs) · Kotak Neo (10-year Muhurat record) · Groww (timings, settlement) · Choice (timings, holidays) · Bajaj Broking · Business Today. Explainers draw on Zerodha Varsity. Today's Muhurat results come after press time. Not investment advice.

World Money

THE WEEK THAT WAS · THE WEEK AHEAD

THE BIG STORY · WEEKEND REVIEW

A tale of two markets: India's best week in five years, Wall Street's worst since June

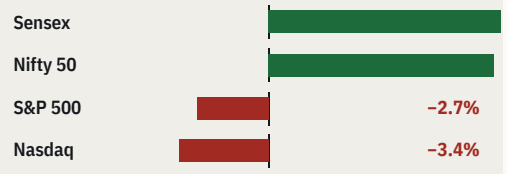
The same week, opposite moods. Next up is Tuesday's US inflation report, which arrives with a strange gap in it.

While the Sensex soared 8.8%, the **S&P 500**, America's main index of 500 big companies, lost 2.7% for the week, and the tech-heavy **Nasdaq** lost 3.4%. The damage came mostly on Thursday, when artificial-intelligence and chip shares crashed and the Nasdaq fell more than 5%. Friday's bounce (S&P 7,376.86, Nasdaq 24,579.42, Dow 51,285.73) won back only part of it.

Friday's strong jobs report (165,000 new jobs) added a new worry: that the US central bank could raise interest rates in December. The 10-year US government bond yield rose to about **4.87%** and the dollar index climbed 0.7% to 102.28, Rio Times reports.

Coming up: on **Tuesday 10 November**, America publishes its October inflation numbers. StockTitan notes they will show the month's price change but **no yearly inflation rate** for overall prices, because October 2025 prices were never collected during last year's long US government shutdown. Without a year-ago figure, there is nothing to compare against. Producer prices follow on Friday.

THIS WEEK'S SCORECARD



Week ended Friday 6 November.

US FEAR GAUGE (VIX), FRIDAY

25.64 ▼ 9%



10 calm 20 nervous 50 panic

WEEK AHEAD (US TIME)

- Mon · Take-Two, Rocket Lab results
- Tue · US inflation (CPI) · CoreWeave
- Thu · Cisco, Applied Materials
- Fri · US producer prices · Japan's big banks

WHY SHOULD SOMEONE IN MUMBAI CARE?

Money is restless. This week a lot of it left nervous US tech shares and some of it landed in India, which helped your neighbour's mutual fund. But if Tuesday's inflation report looks hot and US rates look set to rise, the flow can turn. Watch the rupee too: at about ₹93.9 to the dollar, it already makes foreign holidays, imported gadgets and fuel costly.

JARGON BUSTER

CPI
Consumer Price Index: the price of a typical basket of shopping, tracked month by month to measure inflation.

Year-on-year
Comparing a number with the same month last year. Missing last year's data breaks this comparison.

Dollar index
A score of the US dollar against six major currencies. Up means the dollar is getting stronger.

Earnings season
The weeks when companies report profits. It slows down now: only 11 S&P 500 firms report next week.

OIL & GOLD

Brent near $98, gold near $4,070

Brent crude ended the week around $98 a barrel and US crude near $91. Gold was about $4,066–4,079 an ounce; sources differ slightly on Friday's close.

EUROPE

Shoppers pull back

Euro-area retail sales fell 0.7% in September, far worse than the 0.1% dip expected, Eurostat data show.

NEXT BIG ONE

Nvidia on 17 November

The AI chip giant reports a week on Tuesday, along with Disney. After Thursday's chip crash, the whole market will be watching.

Sources: StockTitan earnings and economic calendar, week of 9 Nov · Rio Times global briefing, 7 Nov (yields, dollar, VIX, Europe, oil, gold) · Yahoo Finance (Friday closes, week) · Just Security, citing Axios (Nasdaq fall) · HDFC Sky (Sensex week, rupee). Rio Times notes it uses an automated newsroom; its figures are treated as secondary. Not investment advice.

World Affairs

WHO'S DOING WHAT, AND WHY IT MATTERS

THE BIG STORY · UNITED STATES & IRAN

Talk and strike: US hits Iran's Qeshm Island as Qatar's 48-hour peace plan waits

Trump calls them "minor strikes". Iran says the Strait of Hormuz stays shut until all seven of its conditions are met.

On Saturday, President Trump confirmed what he called "minor strikes" on **Qeshm**, an Iranian island at the mouth of the Strait of Hormuz, saying an air-defence system was "knocked out in about 15 minutes". Iranian state media placed two missile hits in the Suza area of the island, and state broadcaster IRIB reported no casualties. It was the second strike on Qeshm in five days.

Yet the two sides are still talking, through **Qatar**. On Friday, Qatar put forward a **48-hour, two-stage plan**. Stage one: America lifts its blockade of Iran's ports, and Iran lets UN nuclear inspectors (the IAEA) back into its sites. Stage two: Iran reopens Hormuz and commits to nuclear talks. Neither side had accepted it by Saturday, though Qatar's prime minister spoke of "significant progress".

Iran's army spokesman, Brig. Gen. Mohammad Akraminia, said the strait stays closed until Iran's demands are met. The human cost at sea keeps rising: the UN's shipping agency, the IMO, says at least **25 seafarers** have been killed and **130 attacks** made on merchant ships in and around Hormuz since 28 February.

QATAR'S TWO-STEP PLAN

STAGE 1
USA: lifts blockade of Iran's ports
Iran: lets IAEA inspectors back in

↓

STAGE 2
Iran: reopens the Strait of Hormuz
Both: begin nuclear talks

Status Saturday: not accepted by either side

THE INDIA ANGLE

House of Saud reports that Iran has formally **exempted India**, along with China, Iraq and Qatar, from its Hormuz transit restrictions, which would matter hugely for the oil and gas India buys from the Gulf. We have not seen independent confirmation. The danger to Indian sailors is real: the IMO's list of recent deaths includes an Indian seafarer on the dhow MSV Al Jusufi on 2 November; Oman's coast guard rescued 13 others.

TWO TRACKS AT ONCE

Force	Talks	Leverage
strikes on Qeshm, blockade	Qatar's plan, "in communicatio	Hormuz kept closed

Both sides are using pressure to win better terms at the table.

AROUND THE WORLD

RUSSIA & UKRAINE

A "big agreement"?

Trump said he met Russian envoy Kirill Dmitriev at the White House and spoke of a Ukraine peace deal that "might involve all of Europe", the New York Times reports.

Why it matters: Europe is still deciding who would speak for it.

UKRAINE

Satellites running out

Ukraine's Starshield satellite contract with the US ends mid-2027, and Kyiv is urgently seeking a new one, its embassy told Reuters.

Why it matters: troops depend on it for communications.

GULF

Missile over Riyadh

The Saudi-led coalition said it destroyed a Houthi cruise missile over Riyadh on Saturday. Houthi claims of attacks on Aramco sites are unconfirmed.

Why it matters: the war's edges keep spreading.

DIPLOMACY

G7 in Paris this week

Foreign ministers of the G7 rich democracies meet in Paris on Monday and Tuesday, with Iran high on the agenda.

Why it matters: a united line adds pressure on both sides.

US POLITICS

A new Congress waits

Democrats won both houses on 3 November, but the new Congress sits only from January. Until then, Trump keeps his current war powers.

Why it matters: the clock shapes Washington's choices.

ASIA

Malaysia's Najib stays put

Former PM Najib Razak's move to house arrest was halted while lawyers clarify his royal pardon, Reuters and AP report.

Why it matters: a test of Malaysia's courts and monarchy.

Sources: House of Saud (Qeshm strikes, Qatar plan, 7 Nov) · House of Saud (IMO figures, citing Trend and APA) · House of Saud (Akraminia) · House of Saud (India exemption, headline) · House of Saud (Riyadh) · Just Security, 6 Nov (citing NYT, Reuters, AP) · CBS News (G7). Much of the Gulf reporting is single-sourced; Houthi and IRGC claims are unconfirmed.

Defence

ARMY · NAVY · AIR FORCE · MADE IN INDIA

AIR FORCE THE BIG STORY

The seat that saves pilots: Britain's Martin-Baker plans a ₹380 crore factory in Karnataka

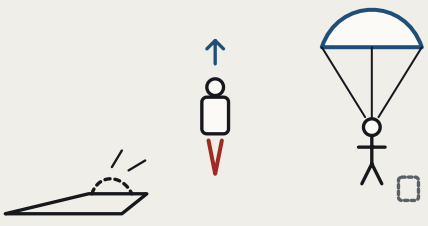
The world's best-known maker of ejection seats wants to build them in India, PTI reports, adding another piece to the country's growing aircraft supply chain.

When a fighter jet is crippled, a pilot has seconds to live. An **ejection seat** fires the pilot, still strapped in, out of the cockpit and opens a parachute automatically. British firm **Martin-Baker** has made these seats since the 1940s, and many Indian Air Force jets already carry them. Now, PTI reports, it plans a **₹380 crore** manufacturing facility in Karnataka.

The company has a moving origin story. It was founded in 1934 by engineer James Martin and test pilot Valentine Baker. When Baker died in a crash during a test flight in 1942, Martin turned his mind to helping pilots escape. The details of the Karnataka plant, such as its exact site, jobs and timeline, were not in the report we saw.

It joins a busy week for India's air industry. The IAF signed an agreement with **IIT Madras** to develop a secure airborne communication system, and Brazil's Embraer is weighing India as a production hub for its **C-390** military transport plane, according to idrw.org.

HOW AN EJECTION WORKS



1 · canopy off 2 · rocket fires 3 · parachute

A simple sketch. Modern seats do all of this automatically in a few seconds.

HAL'S ENGINE STRETCH

Target life 3,000 h

HAL is using digital models to push the Su-30MKI's AL-31FP engines beyond their original life limits, idrw.org reports.

ARMY DIWALI

Rajnath at the LAC

Defence Minister Rajnath Singh was scheduled to visit Darjeeling on Saturday to celebrate Diwali with soldiers posted near the Line of Actual Control with China, IANS reports.

JOINT EXERCISE

Tiger Triumph done

India and US forces completed the fifth Tiger Triumph, a tri-service amphibious exercise practising disaster relief from the sea.

ARMY NEIGHBOURS

Rahat Mitra with Myanmar

Indian and Myanmar troops are training together in Exercise Rahat Mitra, focused on humanitarian aid and disaster relief.

DEFENCE WORDS DECODED

Ejection seat
A rocket-powered seat that throws the pilot clear of a failing jet and opens a parachute.

HADR
Humanitarian Assistance and Disaster Relief: the military helping after floods, quakes and cyclones.

Amphibious
Working from sea to land: ships landing troops and supplies on a beach.

Loitering munition
A "kamikaze drone" that circles over an area, picks a target and dives onto it.

NAVY CARRIER

Bigger lifts for Rafale M

The Navy and Dassault will modify the aircraft lifts on India's carriers so the new Rafale M fighters can move between deck and hangar.

EXPORTS

Indian drones go abroad

Bengaluru's Flying Wedge Defence says it has exported its FWD loitering munition; buyer countries weren't named. Vietnam's interest in BrahMos also made news.

Sources: idrw.org / PTI (Martin-Baker) · idrw.org / PIB (IAF–IIT Madras) · idrw.org (C-390) · idrw.org (AL-31FP) · IANS (Rajnath) · IANS (Tiger Triumph) · IANS (Rahat Mitra) · idrw.org (Rafale M lifts) · idrw.org (Flying Wedge). Several items are from short news summaries; full details may differ. Martin-Baker history from the company's public record.

Sports

CRICKET · FORMULA 1 · FOOTBALL

CRICKET · INDIA IN NEW ZEALAND · 2ND ODI

Brar's four, then the rain: India edge Wellington by 4 runs to lead 2–0

A low-scoring thriller ended early when the weather closed in, with India just ahead of the rain-rules target.

Fast bowler **Gurnoor Brar** had the day of his life. He took **4 for 30** in 10 overs, with two maidens, his best figures in one-day internationals, and New Zealand were bowled out for **134** in 41 overs of a match cut to 47 overs a side. Daryl Mitchell made 55 and captain Mitchell Santner 31. Axar Patel and Anshul Kamboj took two wickets each.

Chasing 135 should have been easy. It wasn't. Shubman Gill fell first ball, and Kyle Jamieson and Jacob Duffy took three wickets each. Shreyas Iyer (30) and Rohit Sharma (23) steadied things; Virat Kohli made only 7. At **113 for 7** after 26 overs, with KL Rahul unbeaten on 26, the rain returned and the match was called off. India were **4 runs ahead** of the DLS target of 109 at that point, so they won.

India now lead the five-match series 2–0. New Zealand must win the next game to stay alive.

ODI SERIES · AFTER 2 OF 5

IND	2
NZ	0

2ND ODI: NZ 134 (41 OV) · IND 113/7 (26 OV) · INDIA WON BY 4 RUNS (DLS)

HOW THE DLS SUM WORKED

India	113
Par score	109

After 26 overs and 7 wickets down, India needed 109 to be “on par”. They had 113.

MARK YOUR CALENDAR (IST)

- Tonight 10:30 PM · Brazil GP race
- Sun 7:30 PM · Crystal Palace v Liverpool
- Sun 10:00 PM · Man United v Aston Villa
- 19 Nov · 1st Test, Wellington

FORMULA 1 · BRAZIL QUALIFYING

Norris on pole in the rain

In a soaking session at Interlagos that was red-flagged almost at once, McLaren's **Lando Norris** took pole in 1m 27.470s, ahead of Mercedes' **George Russell** and championship leader **Kimi Antonelli**, then Charles Leclerc and Liam Lawson. Max Verstappen set no time in 16th and starts from the back after penalties; Russell and both Ferraris also have grid penalties (10 places each for the Ferraris, for new engine parts), so tonight's grid will look different.

DRIVERS' CHAMPIONSHIP (BEFORE BRAZIL)

Antonelli	380
Verstappen	261
Hamilton	259
Russell	250
Leclerc	245
Norris	221

Points after Mexico. Antonelli leads by 119.

FOOTBALL NOTE

Saturday's Premier League results, including leaders Arsenal against Hull and Manchester City at Nottingham Forest, were not available from our sources at press time. Check them on your phone with your chai; we'll have the table tomorrow.

Sources: Outlook live blog and highlights, 7 Nov · Outlook scorecard page (Brar 4/30) · The Race (qualifying results) · The Race (penalties) · Formula1.com (standings) · theScore (fixture). The full cricket scorecard and player of the match were not available at press time.

The Reading Room

THREE PIECES OF GREAT WRITING, AND WHAT TO LEARN FROM THEM

A Diwali-holiday menu: a funny, painfully true essay about putting things off, a short piece on thinking for yourself, and the next Varsity chapter on how a company sells its shares to the public.

01

HABITS · HUMOUR | 20 MIN READ

"Why Procrastinators Procrastinate" by Tim Urban, Wait But Why

In one line: inside your head, a sensible planner shares the steering wheel with an Instant Gratification Monkey.

Tim Urban draws stick-figure cartoons to explain why we open YouTube when we meant to file our taxes. The **Monkey** only cares about what's easy and fun right now, and the only thing that scares him away is the **Panic Monster**, who shows up when a deadline is close. It's laugh-out-loud funny and then, quietly, quite moving, because almost everyone recognises themselves. Its follow-up, "How to Beat Procrastination", is worth reading next.

STEAL THIS TRICK

Turn a feeling into a character. Giving an abstract struggle a name and a face (the Monkey) makes readers remember the idea, and repeat it to friends.

waitbutwhy.com/2013/10/why-procrastinators-procrastinate.html

02

THINKING | 10 MIN READ

"How to Think for Yourself" by Paul Graham

In one line: some jobs reward agreeing with everyone, others reward being right when everyone else is wrong, and you should know which one you're in.

Graham sorts people into the conventional-minded and the independent-minded. In fields like science, investing and start-ups, he argues, being right is not enough: you must be right about something most people haven't noticed yet. He then offers practical habits for keeping an independent mind, like staying curious, keeping a skeptical eye on the latest fashion in ideas, and spending time with people who think differently. It's short, clear and makes a good companion to this week's market swings.

STEAL THIS TRICK

Split the world in two. A simple two-way division (conventional vs independent) gives the reader a frame they can instantly apply to themselves and the people they know.

paulgraham.com/think.html

03

MONEY · INDIA | 10 MIN READ

"The IPO Markets – Part 2" by Zerodha Varsity

In one line: what actually happens, step by step, when a company decides to list on the stock exchange.

Yesterday's pick introduced the idea of an IPO. Part 2 walks through the journey itself: hiring investment bankers, writing the offer document (the prospectus) that SEBI checks, fixing a price band, and opening the issue for people like you to apply. With Mahanadi Coalfields and others expected to list soon (page 1), this is exactly the right moment to understand what you're reading in those IPO ads.

STEAL THIS TRICK

Write it as a checklist. A complicated process becomes friendly when it's told as numbered steps, each with one job.

zerodha.com/varsity/chapter/the-ipo-markets-part-2

Read times are rough estimates. Links go to the original publishers.

The Book Review

TODAY: FICTION · INDIAN SHORT STORIES

R. K. NARAYAN



Malgudi Days

★★★★★

Genre: Fiction / short stories
First published: 1943
Length: about 250 pages
Style: gentle, funny, very short tales
Read it: one story with each cup of tea

REVIEW · *MALGUDI DAYS*

A town that never existed, full of people you have definitely met

Malgudi is not on any map. R. K. Narayan invented this sleepy South Indian town, with its market road, its river and its railway station, and then filled it with people so ordinary and so real that millions of readers feel they grew up there.

This collection of short stories is the easiest way in. There's a street astrologer who knows nothing about the stars but a great deal about people, and who meets a stranger from his own past one evening ("An Astrologer's Day"). There's a little girl who refuses to believe her friend, a servant boy, is a thief ("Leela's Friend"). There's a town that votes to pull down the statue of a British officer, then discovers who he really was ("Lawley Road").

Narayan never shouts. His sentences are plain, his jokes are quiet, and most stories end with a small twist that makes you smile or catches in your throat. Many readers know Malgudi from the 1986 TV series directed by Shankar Nag, and the books are illustrated by Narayan's younger brother, the cartoonist **R. K. Laxman**. A few details feel dated now, but the human comedy doesn't.

> *"He knew no more of what was going to happen to others than he knew what was going to happen to himself next minute."*
>
> "An Astrologer's Day" · In plain words: the fortune-teller is guessing, and so are we all, but he's very good at reading faces.

THREE THINGS THIS BOOK TEACHES

1

Small is enough

A story doesn't need wars or spies. A lost letter or a broken promise in a small town can hold a whole life.

2

Read the room

Narayan's astrologer succeeds by watching people closely. Good listening looks a lot like magic.

3

Kindness, quietly

His characters are foolish and stubborn, yet he treats each one with warmth. So, gradually, do you.

READ IT IF YOU…

- want a holiday book you can dip in and out of
- loved the Malgudi Days TV show as a child
- are short on time: most stories take under 15 minutes

LIKED IT? READ NEXT

- *Swami and Friends* by R. K. Narayan, his first Malgudi novel
- *The Guide* by R. K. Narayan, a longer, deeper Malgudi tale
- *The Room on the Roof* by Ruskin Bond

Puzzles & Games

EIGHT BRAIN GAMES · EASY → HARD · ANSWERS ON PAGE 11

1 · EASY · WORDS

Fruit swap

Rearrange the letters of this fruit to make another fruit.

L E M O N

2 · EASY · NUMBERS

What comes next?

Look at the gaps between the numbers.

2 5 10 17 26 ?

3 · MEDIUM · WORDS

Winter to summer

Change one letter at a time to turn COLD into WARM. Every step must be a real word.

COLD → ? → ? → ? → WARM

4 · MEDIUM · LOGIC

The sweet-shop bill

A box of kaju katli and a box of soan papdi cost ₹700 together. The kaju katli costs ₹300 more than the soan papdi. What does each box cost?

5 · MEDIUM · GRID

Mini Sudoku

Fill in the grid so every row, column and 2×2 box has 1, 2, 3 and 4.

	1		2
2			
			3
	4		

6 · MEDIUM · TODAY'S NEWS

Where did it start?

The Sensex gained 6,568.49 points this week and closed Friday at 81,028.02. At what level did it begin the week?

7 · HARD · NUMBERS

The flipped number

I'm a two-digit number. My digits add up to 11. Swap my digits and I become 27 bigger. What number am I?

8 · HARD · WORDPLAY

Read the picture

What common phrase does this show?

ONCE
TIME

Hint: many bedtime stories begin this way.

Facts, Figures & Takes

THINGS TO SAY AT THE DIWALI PARTY

8 of 10

Muhurat trading sessions in the last decade in which the Nifty closed higher.

₹28.7 lakh cr

Value added to BSE-listed companies in one week, HDFC Sky reports.

25

Seafarers killed around Hormuz since February, according to the IMO.

POCKET CARTOON



"Pole position? At Interlagos this year it was more of a boat position."

THE TAKE · OUR OPINION

Why buy shares on a festival? Because rituals are good for money

Muhurat trading looks like superstition: an hour of buying shares because the stars are right. The numbers back that up. In the last ten years the Nifty's Muhurat move was never bigger than 1% either way, which is nothing special at all.

But the ritual does something useful. Once a year, millions of families think about their savings together, at the same time. Many buy a single share or start a small monthly investment. The habit that sticks is worth far more than any lucky hour.

Our view: keep the ritual, drop the expectation. Use Diwali as the yearly day you check your savings, top them up a little, and decide not to panic at the next bad week. That is a muhurat that really pays.

This is the Gazette's opinion, not financial advice.

MONEY IDEA OF THE DAY: THE DIWALI CHECK-UP

Before the sweets run out, spend 15 minutes on three questions. One: do I have at least three months of expenses saved for emergencies? Two: is my monthly investment still running? Three: did this year's raise or bonus get saved, or quietly spent?

Write the answers on a slip of paper and keep it with your Diwali lamp. Next year, compare.

DID YOU KNOW?

Lakshmi's owl

In Hindu tradition, the goddess Lakshmi, worshipped tonight, rides an owl. And a group of owls in English is called a "parliament".

What DLS stands for

Cricket's rain rule is named after Frank Duckworth, Tony Lewis and later Steven Stern: two statisticians and the professor who updated their method.

Tyres that pump water

Pirelli says F1's full wet tyres can clear about 85 litres of water per second at top speed. Not enough at Interlagos yesterday.

The Common Man's home

R. K. Laxman's famous cartoon character, the Common Man, has a statue in Pune, the city where Laxman spent his later years.

Fireworks town

Sivakasi in Tamil Nadu makes most of India's firecrackers; it is often said to produce around 90% of them.

The thin channel

Qeshm, in today's world news, is Iran's largest island, lying right in the Strait of Hormuz.

Figures from pages 1 and 3. Facts from standard reference works, Pirelli's published tyre data and the ICC's description of DLS; the Sivakasi share is a widely quoted estimate.

Ten Words for Today

LEARN THEM, THEN USE ONE BEFORE DINNER

1 **Luminous** adj. · LOO-mih-nus

Full of light; shining, especially in the dark.

"The building was luminous with fairy lights for Diwali."

2 **Deluge** noun · DEL-yooj

A huge flood of water; or an overwhelming amount of anything.

"Qualifying in Brazil was held in a deluge."

3 **Clandestine** adj. · klan-DES-tin

Kept secret, often because it isn't allowed.

"The two sides held clandestine talks through Qatar."

4 **Pragmatic** adj. · prag-MAT-ik

Dealing with things sensibly and practically, not by theory.

"A pragmatic investor keeps the SIP running in bad weeks."

5 **Gregarious** adj. · grih-GAIR-ee-us

Fond of company; sociable.

"My gregarious uncle visits ten homes every Diwali night."

6 **Meticulous** adj. · meh-TIK-yuh-lus

Showing great attention to detail; very careful.

"She is meticulous about her rangoli, dot by dot."

7 **Ominous** adj. · OM-ih-nus

Giving the feeling that something bad is about to happen.

"Ominous clouds gathered over Wellington."

8 **Benevolent** adj. · buh-NEV-uh-lunt

Kind, generous and wishing good for others.

"Lakshmi is worshipped as a benevolent goddess of plenty."

9 **Scintillating** adj. · SIN-tih-lay-ting

Sparkling; or brilliantly clever and lively.

"Brar's scintillating spell set up India's win."

10 **Reverie** noun · REV-uh-ree

A pleasant daydream in which you are lost in thought.

"A Malgudi story can drift you into a happy reverie."

TODAY'S CHALLENGE

Words 1 and 9 both describe sparkle. Use **one** of them tonight to describe the lights in your neighbourhood, out loud, to someone.

Skill of the Day

TRAVEL · ABOUT 2 MINUTES PER SHIRT · DIFFICULTY: EASY

TRAVEL · AS PROMISED YESTERDAY

How to fold a shirt so it comes out of a suitcase without creases

Heading out for Bhai Dooj or a holiday trip? A neat fold keeps your shirts ready to wear, saves space, and spares you a hunt for an iron at the other end.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

A clean, ironed shirt	A flat surface: a bed or table	Optional: a magazine or stiff card	Optional: tissue paper or a thin plastic bag

1 Button it up

Do up the top, middle and bottom buttons (or all of them). This keeps the front flat and the shirt's shape square.

2 Face down, smooth out

Lay the shirt **front side down** on the bed. Smooth out every wrinkle with your palms, from the centre outwards. A magazine laid on the back now helps keep the fold sharp.

3 Fold the first side

Fold one side of the shirt towards the middle, so the fold line runs from the **middle of the shoulder** straight down. The side should reach roughly the centre of the back.

4 Lay the sleeve flat

Fold that sleeve back down so it lies straight along the folded edge. For long sleeves, fold the cuff up once so it stays inside the outline.

5 Repeat on the other side

Do the same with the other side and sleeve. You now have a long, neat rectangle, about the width of a magazine.

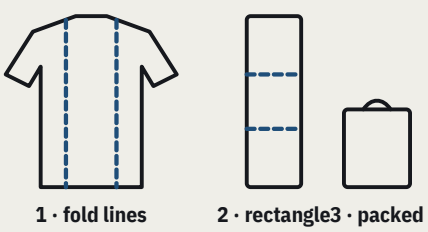
6 Fold the length

Fold the bottom up by a third, then once more so the hem meets the collar. Fewer folds mean fewer creases, so only fold twice.

7 Turn and pack

Flip it over: the collar and front should look like a shirt in a shop. Pack shirts flat at the **top** of the suitcase, alternating collars left and right so the pile stays level.

THE FOLD, FROM THE BACK



Blue dashes: where to fold

Fold from mid-shoulder, not from the armpit, for a neat outline.

⚠ SAFETY AND CARE

- Don't overstuff the suitcase and force the zip; heavy bags strain backs and break handles. Lift with bent knees.
- Pack shoes and liquids in separate bags at the bottom so leaks and dirt can't reach clean shirts.
- Never fold a damp shirt: it can grow mould and smell in a closed bag.

PRO TIP

Creased anyway? Hang the shirt in the bathroom while you take a **hot shower**. The steam relaxes most light creases in ten minutes.

Tomorrow's skill: how to make a perfect cup of masala chai, from whole spices.

PUZZLE ANSWERS (PAGE 8) · TURN THE PAPER UPSIDE DOWN

1. MELON · 2. 37 (gaps grow 3, 5, 7, 9, 11; each number is a square plus 1) · 3. COLD → CORD → WORD → WORM → WARM · 4. Kaju katli ₹500, soan papdi ₹200 · 5. Rows: 4 1 3 2 / 2 3 1 4 / 1 2 4 3 / 3 4 2 1 · 6. 74,459.53 · 7. 47 (4 + 7 = 11, and 74 − 47 = 27) · 8. ONCE UPON A TIME